



The 2025 Touchstone Conference

GREAT & WONDERFUL DAYS

*Recovering the Christian Life
in a Post-Christian Age*

— SPEAKERS —

Paul Kingsnorth

Jonathan Pageau

Rod Dreher

Matthew Crawford

Richard Rohlin

Hans Boersma

Douglas Farrow

R. V. Young

C. R. Wiley

**Sept.
25-27,
2025**

Location:
TRINITY
INTERNATIONAL
UNIVERSITY
*Bannockburn,
Illinois*

Sept. 25

Thursday Late Afternoon



4:00 P.M.

• **Registration Begins**

Visit Our Sponsors: Eighth Day Books; Furrowed Brow Books;
St. Basil Center for Orthodox Thought and Culture; The Symbolic World

**eighth day
BOOKS**



The 2025 Touchstone Conference — Great & Wonderful Days

Thursday Evening

Sept. 25

6:45 P.M.

- J. Douglas Johnson
Welcome & Opening Remarks

7:00 P.M.

- Douglas Farrow
MINORITY REPORT

8:00 P.M.

- Hans Boersma
MIRACLES
Why We Will Walk on Water

9:00 P.M.

- Reception at La Quinta Inn & Suites

DOUGLAS FARROW is Professor of Theology and Ethics at McGill University, Montreal. He is the author of *Ascension Theology*, *Theological Negotiations*, *1 & 2 Thessalonians* (Brazos) and other books. Read more from him at his substack, *Desiring a Better Country*, douglasfarrow.substack.com. He is a senior editor for *Touchstone*.

HANS BOERSMA teaches theology at Nashotah House Theological Seminary in Wisconsin and is ordained as a priest in the Anglican Church in North America. He has written about sacramental ontology (*Heavenly Participation*), patristic exegesis (*Scripture as Real Presence*), and the practice of *lectio divina* (*Pierced by Love*). His forthcoming book on the metaphysics of creation is tentatively titled *Theophanizing Love*.

PAUL KINGSNORTH is the author of nine books—three novels, two poetry collections and four works of non-fiction—all of which, it turns out, tell the same

Sept. 26

Friday Morning

9:00 A.M.

- Paul Kingsnorth
AGAINST THE MACHINE

10:00 A.M.

- Jonathan Pageau
THIS IS THE DAY
Remember, Celebrate, Create

10:45 A.M.

- Break

11:15 A.M.

- Richard Rohlin
THE DEEP PATTERN
**Re-Enchanting Time Through Medieval
Universal History**

NOON

- Lunch

story: how we walked away from the wild world, and how we might get home again, if we can. His new book is *Against the Machine: The Unmaking of Humanity*. He lives in the west of Ireland with his family, a dog, some chickens, and a lot of trees. His website can be found at www.paulkingsnorth.net.

JONATHAN PAGEAU is a renowned liturgical artist, writer, and public speaker. Through his popular YouTube channel *The Symbolic World*, he has become a sought-out interpreter of the deep patterns in stories. With his 2022 publication of *God's Dog: Monster*, a graphic novel invented with his brother Matthieu Pageau

The 2025 Touchstone Conference — **Great & Wonderful Days**

1:30 P.M.

- Jonathan Pageau, Paul Kingsnorth,
Hans Boersma, C. R. Wiley
PANEL DISCUSSION

2:30 P.M.

- R. V. Young
WITH MORTAL VOICE, UNCHANGED
Paradise Lost and the Fortunate Fall

3:30 P.M.

- Break

5:00 P.M.

- Dinner

and artist Cord Nielson, Jonathan proved himself a powerful storyteller in his own right. The project's successful crowdfunding encouraged him to continue his efforts to reclaim the storytelling landscape by starting a publishing company called Symbolic World Press.

RICHARD ROHLIN is a software developer, Germanic philologist, and Orthodox Christian living in Texas with his wife and children. He speaks and publishes on Germanic poetry, the Inklings, and the Sacramental Imagination. He regularly contributes to Jonathan Pageau's *The Symbolic World* YouTube channel through the Universal History series, which has recently launched a 6-week course studying the epic poem *Beowulf*. Richard co-hosts The Amon Sul Podcast, and has published several works of fiction and non-fiction.

R. V. YOUNG is Professor of English Emeritus at North Carolina State University, a former editor of *Modern Age: A Quarterly Review*, and the author of

Sept. 26

Friday Evening

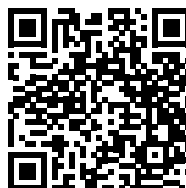
7:00 P.M.

- **Matthew B. Crawford**
CAN CHRISTIANITY BE NOBLE?

9:00 P.M.

- Reception at La Quinta Inn & Suites

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Shakespeare and the Idea of Western Civilization. He and his wife are parishioners at St. Ignatius of Antioch Church in Tarpon Springs, Florida. They have five grown children, fifteen grandchildren, and three great-grandchildren. He is a senior editor of *Touchstone*.

MATTHEW B. CRAWFORD studied physics at UC Santa Barbara and then turned to political philosophy, earning a PhD from the University of Chicago. He has published articles on ancient Greek philosophy, neuroscience, and the philosophy of science. He is the author of *Why We Drive: Toward a Philosophy of the Open Road*; *The World Beyond Your Head: On Becoming an Individual in an Age of Distraction*; and *Shop Class as Soulcraft: An Inquiry into the Value of Work*, a *New York Times* bestseller that has been translated into seven languages.

The 2025 *Touchstone* Conference — **Great & Wonderful Days**

9:00 A.M.

- Rod Dreher
PILGRIMS, NOT TOURISTS
A (Sort of) Argument for Christendom

10:00 A.M.

- Break / Refreshments

10:30 A.M.

- Matthew B. Crawford, Rod Dreher,
Richard Rohlin, C. R. Wiley
PANEL DISCUSSION

11:30 A.M.

- J. Douglas Johnson
Closing Remarks

ROD DREHER is a veteran of three decades of magazine and newspaper journalism and has written three *New York Times* bestsellers—*Live Not By Lies*, *The Benedict Option*, and *The Little Way of Ruthie Leming*—as well as *Crunchy Cons* and *How Dante Can Save Your Life*. He lives in Budapest, Hungary. He is a contributing editor for *Touchstone*.

C. R. Wiley is a senior editor at *Touchstone*, a co-host of *The Theology Pugcast* (a podcast with listeners in 60 countries), and a Presbyterian pastor serving a church in the Pacific Northwest. Besides writing for magazines and publishing books, he has also been a college professor, a commercial real estate investor, a landlord, and a building contractor. Other publications he has written for include: *Modern Reformation*, *Sacred Architecture*, *World Magazine*, *Front Porch Republic*, *National Review*, and *First Things*. His most recent book is *In the House of Tom Bombadil* (2021).



Touchstone
GUILD

The earliest-known English guilds were not craft guilds but Christian confraternities formed to guard town walls and protect guild members. The Touchstone Guild is a small group of private donors who, through financial contributions of \$1,000 or more each year, make up our elite guard protecting everyone at *Touchstone* and the Fellowship of St. James.



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- Invitation to special events
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Touchstone WATCHMEN

For those who would like to give more but do not have the resources for Guild membership, we have established the Touchstone Watchmen. The Watchmen are donors who give \$500–\$999 a year.



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- *Creed & Culture II: A Touchstone Reader*
- Invitation to special events
- Recognition in the March/April issue of *Touchstone*